COLLEGE MUST PREPARE STUDENTS THROUGH HANDS -ON LEARNING

In today's changing times, students must acquire skills alongside education to remain competitive. With Artificial Intelligence (AI) entering every field, the future job market will demand continuous learning and adaptability. By 2030, many existing jobs may disappear or transform, making skill-based education essential.

Practical Education is Key

Theory alone no longer excites students. Practical learning engages them and builds creativity, critical thinking, and social responsibility. To address this, Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU) has introduced Innovation and Design Thinking (IDT) from the first semester, preparing students not just for jobs but also for responsible citizenship.

Internships Made Mandatory

Internships are vital for industry readiness, yet some students misuse them by submitting fake certificates. VTU has launched an online portal making internships compulsory. Currently, 83,000 students are engaged in internships, many leading directly to job offers.

Communication Skills Matter

Technical knowledge alone is not enough. Communication skills are crucial to explain ideas and products effectively. VTU emphasizes training students to combine technical expertise with strong communication abilities.

Curriculum Reform

Curriculum must align with industry needs. Outdated content wastes time and reduces employability. VTU is integrating emerging technologies such as AI, Data Science, Cybersecurity, Renewable Energy, Electric Vehicles, and Drone Technology into its programs.



"As technology changes, we too must upskill accordingly. The jobs that exist today may not exist tomorrow. If we want to remain in the job market, skill-based education is essential. Engineering colleges must also prepare students in ways that meet the requirements of the job market."

PROF. S. VIDYASHANKAR, Vice-Chancellor, VTU

Placement Readiness

Good placements require preparation. Students must acquire communication skills and short-term skill training before entering interviews. For example, when Infosys recruited 1,000 women candidates, only 300 qualified due to lack of readiness.

Essential Skills for Final-Year Students

By the final semester, students must focus on innovation and industry-relevant skills. Enrolling in specialized courses, including online programs, ensures they are prepared for the global job market.

Highlights

- Continuous learning is essential
- Skills must match industry demand
- Practical education should be prioritized
- Innovation and creativity are vital

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